

LESSON ONE

SEEKING GOD

Pursuing a Relationship with God with All
Your Heart

**To determine what it means
to pursue a relationship with
God with all our hearts.**

**What are you looking for
in life?**

**What are you pursuing with
all your heart?**

Every person is searching for something.

- Some pursue success.
- Some pursue happiness.
- Some pursue relationships.
- Some pursue purpose.

But the most important question is this: Are you seeking God?

Before we open the Bible

What are you pursuing with all your heart?

Write the two or three things that actually get your time, money, and attention this year.

ON A SCALE OF 1 TO 10, HOW MUCH EFFORT DO YOU GIVE TO SEEKING GOD?

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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Blessed Are Those Who Seek Him

PSALM 119:1-2 NIV

ALEPH X

¹ Blessed are those whose ways are blameless, who walk according to the law of the Lord. ² Blessed are those who keep his statutes and seek him with all their heart—

WORDS

SOURCE NEEDED • NAME THE
LEXICON

BLESSED

joyful, highly favored

BLAMELESS

living what is right

UNDERSTAND

- To seek God, you must seek His Word with all your heart.
- We seek God by knowing and obeying His Word.
- When you seek God fully, the result is not just temporary happiness, but a deeper and lasting joy.

Do Not Worry

MATTHEW 6:25–34 NIV

VERSES 25 TO 30

²⁵ “Therefore I tell you, do not worry about your life, what you will eat or drink; or about your body, what you will wear. Is not life more than food, and the body more than clothes? ²⁶ Look at the birds of the air; they do not sow or reap or store away in barns, and yet your heavenly Father feeds them. Are you not much more valuable than they? ²⁷ Can any one of you by worrying add a single hour to your life? ²⁸ “And why do you worry about clothes? See how the flowers of the field grow. They do not labor or spin. ²⁹ Yet I tell you that not even Solomon in all his splendor was dressed like one of these. ³⁰ If that is how God clothes the grass of the field, which is here today and tomorrow is thrown into the fire, will he not much more clothe you—you of little faith?

Do Not Worry, continued

MATTHEW 6:25–34 NIV

VERSES 31 TO 34

³¹ So do not worry, saying, ‘What shall we eat?’ or ‘What shall we drink?’ or ‘What shall we wear?’ ³² For the pagans run after all these things, and your heavenly Father knows that you need them. ³³ But seek first his kingdom and his righteousness, and all these things will be given to you as well. ³⁴ Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Each day has enough trouble of its own.

ACTS 242 SUMMARY

Jesus taught His disciples not to worry about food, drink, or clothing. He pointed to the birds and the flowers, which God feeds and clothes, and asked why they would doubt that God would care for them. He said their Father knows what they need, and told them to seek first His kingdom and His righteousness.

Many people do not seek God because they don't believe He has the power to change their lives.

Worry often reveals what we value most. We worry about:

- finances
- career
- relationships

What are some areas in your life that you are tempted to worry about?

Seek First His Kingdom

What does it mean to “seek first His kingdom and His righteousness”? What does God promise if you do?

To “seek first His kingdom” means:

- putting God above your plans
- trusting God with your future
- obeying God even when it is difficult

KEY TRUTH

**When God is first,
everything else finds its
proper place.**

God Is Not Far From Any One of Us

ACTS 17:24–28 NIV

²⁴ “The God who made the world and everything in it is the Lord of heaven and earth and does not live in temples built by human hands. ²⁵ And he is not served by human hands, as if he needed anything. Rather, he himself gives everyone life and breath and everything else. ²⁶ From one man he made all the nations, that they should inhabit the whole earth; and he marked out their appointed times in history and the boundaries of their lands. ²⁷ God did this so that they would seek him and perhaps reach out for him and find him, though he is not far from any one of us. ²⁸ ‘For in him we live and move and have our being.’ As some of your own poets have said, ‘We are his offspring.’

God is near. The question is not whether God is present. The question is whether you are seeking Him.

In the Spirit and in Truth

JOHN 4:23-24 NIV

²³ Yet a time is coming and has now come when the true worshipers will worship the Father in the Spirit and in truth, for they are the kind of worshipers the Father seeks. ²⁴ God is spirit, and his worshipers must worship in the Spirit and in truth.”

WORSHIP IS NOT JUST

- singing
- attending church
- emotional experience

TRUE WORSHIP IS

- sincere, from the heart
- grounded in truth
- consistent in life

God is not looking for perfect people. He is looking for people who are real and willing to seek Him honestly.

When You Seek Me With All Your Heart

JEREMIAH 29:11-13 NIV

¹¹ For I know the plans I have for you,” declares the Lord, “plans to prosper you and not to harm you, plans to give you hope and a future. ¹² Then you will call on me and come and pray to me, and I will listen to you. ¹³ You will seek me and find me when you seek me with all your heart.

UNDERSTAND

God wants to give us hope and a future, but to discover these plans, we must first draw near to Him. The only way to do that is to seek Him with all our hearts.

This is not casual interest. This is full pursuit.

READ ALL THREE

Verse 11 is quoted often and on its own. Read 12 and 13 with it. The promise has a condition attached.

A case study of someone seeking God

Acts 8:26–39

Go to That Chariot

ACTS 8:26–39 NIV

VERSES 26 TO 29

²⁶ Now an angel of the Lord said to Philip, “Go south to the road—the desert road—that goes down from Jerusalem to Gaza.” ²⁷ So he started out, and on his way he met an Ethiopian eunuch, an important official in charge of all the treasury of the Kandake (which means “queen of the Ethiopians”). This man had gone to Jerusalem to worship, ²⁸ and on his way home was sitting in his chariot reading the Book of Isaiah the prophet. ²⁹ The Spirit told Philip, “Go to that chariot and stay near it.”

Unless Someone Explains It

ACTS 8:26–39 NIV

VERSES 30 TO 33

³⁰ Then Philip ran up to the chariot and heard the man reading Isaiah the prophet. “Do you understand what you are reading?” Philip asked. ³¹ “How can I,” he said, “unless someone explains it to me?” So he invited Philip to come up and sit with him. ³² This is the passage of Scripture the eunuch was reading:

“He was led like a sheep to the slaughter,
and as a lamb before its shearer is silent,
so he did not open his mouth.

³³ In his humiliation he was deprived of justice.
Who can speak of his descendants?
For his life was taken from the earth.”

³⁴ The eunuch asked Philip, “Tell me, please, who is the prophet talking about, himself or someone else?” ³⁵ Then Philip began with that very passage of Scripture and told him the good news about Jesus. ³⁶ As they traveled along the road, they came to some water and the eunuch said, “Look, here is water. What can stand in the way of my being baptized?” ³⁸ And he gave orders to stop the chariot. Then both Philip and the eunuch went down into the water and Philip baptized him. ³⁹ When they came up out of the water, the Spirit of the Lord suddenly took Philip away, and the eunuch did not see him again, but went on his way rejoicing.

ACTS 242 SUMMARY

An angel sent Philip to the desert road to Gaza. There he met an Ethiopian official, a man of great authority, returning from Jerusalem and reading the prophet Isaiah in his chariot. He did not understand what he read, so he asked Philip to explain it. Philip told him the good news about Jesus. When they came to water the man asked to be baptized, and after his baptism he went on his way rejoicing.

SACRIFICE

He traveled a long distance to seek God.

HUMILITY

Although he was important, he was willing to learn from others.

OBEDIENCE

When he understood the truth, he responded immediately.

He rejoiced after his baptism because he now had a real relationship with God.

Ask, Seek, Knock

MATTHEW 7:7-8 NIV

⁷ “Ask and it will be given to you; seek and you will find; knock and the door will be opened to you. ⁸ For everyone who asks receives; the one who seeks finds; and to the one who knocks, the door will be opened.

The promise is not made to the curious. It is made to the one who asks, seeks, and knocks — three verbs, all of them active.

REFLECT **Answer Honestly**

What am I truly seeking in life?

What takes most of my time, attention, and energy?

Do I only seek God when I have problems?

Am I willing to seek God with all my heart?

Look again at the number you gave at the start. Would you give the same number now?

CHALLENGE

- 01 Pray and talk to God daily
- 02 Read the Bible every day, starting with the Gospel of John
- 03 Make time for God, not just when convenient
- 04 Continue this study and take the next step

P R A Y E R

God,

I want to seek You with all my heart. Help me to desire You more
than anything else.

Teach me to trust You, follow You, and live according to Your
Word. Guide me as I begin this journey to know You more.

Amen.

NEXT

Lesson 2

Word of God

Making the Bible your standard for life